Charles Pletcher

Tufts University
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Classics and Comparative Literature, Columbia University, 2023
Dissertation: *Props and Power: Objects and economies of knowledge in four plays of Sophocles*
Committee: Nancy Worman (chair), Helene Foley, Elizabeth Scharffenberger
Examiners: Joshua Billings, Laura McClure

M.Phil. Classics, Columbia University, 2019

M.A. Comparative Literature, Dartmouth College, 2013

B.A. Classics (honors) and Comparative Literature, Brown University, 2012
Liberal Arts, Deep Springs College

EMPLOYMENT

Postdoctoral Scholar, Tufts University, Department of Classical Studies, Spring 2026–Present

Lecturer, Tufts University, Department of Classical Studies, Fall 2024–Fall 2025

Research Software Engineer, University of Lausanne, Institute of Archaeology and Classical Studies (PI: Matteo Romanello), 2023–2024

PUBLICATIONS

Monographs

In progress: *Speech Acts: Narrative, Performance, and the Manipulation of Knowledge in the Dramas of Sophocles*

Peer-Reviewed Articles

Under review – Pletcher, Charles. "The Cast of Messengers: An approach to style and lexis in the news-bringers of Attic tragedy."

Pletcher, Charles. Forthcoming (Fall 2026). “The Robe Made Flesh: Offstage Action and Onstage Narrative in Sophocles’ *Trachiniae*.” *Helios*.

Pletcher, Charles. 2024. “Repetition (Antígona’s Version): Going Back in Griselda Gambaro’s *Antígona furiosa*.” *International Journal of the Classical Tradition* 32: 89–110.

Co-Authored Peer-Reviewed Articles

In preparation – **Pletcher, Charles**, Sarah Abowitz, and Gregory Crane, “Style and Characterization in Thucydides: A computational approach.”

Crane, Gregory, James Tauber, Alison Babeu, Lisa Cerrato, **Charles Pletcher**, Clifford Wolfman, Sergiusz Kazmierski, and Farnoosh Shamsian. 2025. “The Sixth Generation of the Perseus Digital Library and a Workflow for Open Philology.” *Transformations: A DARIAH Journal*. https://doi.org/10.46298/transformations.14780.

Chapters in Edited Volumes

Pletcher, Charles and Matteo Romanello. Forthcoming. “Commentaries.” In *The Oxford Handbook of Digital Classical Studies*, edited by Elton Barker, Olympia Bobou, and Rubina Raja. Oxford UP.

Pletcher, Charles and Matteo Romanello. Forthcoming. “The Makeup of *Ajax*: Reconstructing Networks of Interpretation through the Commentary Tradition.” In *Tall Edifices Supported by Strong Foundations: Open Data in Ancient and Byzantine Studies*, edited by Valeria Vitale and Gabriel Bodard.

TALKS

Invited Talks

Pletcher, Charles, “Failing Again (and Again): Queer Possibilities in Supergiant Games’ *Hades II*,” Cal. State, Long Beach, Center for the History of Video Games, Technology and Critical Play (online), December 2025.

Nadel, Peter, **Charles Pletcher**, and Gregory Crane. “Infrastructure for an Emergent Open Ecosystem in the Humanities,” Connecticut Digital Humanities, February 2025.

Romanello, Matteo and **Charles Pletcher**, “Many Commentaries, One Ajax: The Challenges and Opportunities of the Ajax Multi-Commentary Platform,” Pelagios Visualization Network (online), May 2024.

Panels Organized

Van Geel, Lien and **Charles Pletcher**, "Size Matters? Big Books and the Idea of the Classical," Classical Association of the Atlantic States, New Brunswick, NJ, October 2024.

Select Conference Talks (Peer-Reviewed Abstracts)

Pletcher, Charles, "Towards a Computational Approach to News-Bringers in Ancient Greek Tragedy," Dramatic Corpora (DraCor) Summit, Berlin, Germany, September 2025.

Pletcher, Charles and Matteo Romanello, "Actor–Network Theory and the *Ajax* Multi-Commentary," Annual Meeting of the Society for Classical Studies, Philadelphia, PA, January 2025.

Pletcher, Charles, "Wild Failure: Skill and Queer Receptions in the Roguelike *Hades 2*." Antiquity in Media Studies Annual Conference. Virtual, November 2024.

Van Geel, Lien and **Charles Pletcher**, "Multi-vocality and Cervantes' Catalogue of Classics," Classical Association of the Atlantic States, New Brunswick, NJ, October 2024.

Najem-Meyer, **Charles Pletcher**, and Matteo Romanello, "The Ajax Multi-Commentary: A Digital Platform for the Comparative Analysis of Classical Commentaries," Annual Conference of the Alliance of Digital Humanities Organizations, Washington, DC, August 2024.

Pletcher, Charles, "Write What You Know: Enabling open, collaborative publications with commercial tools," Ancient MakerSpaces, Annual Meeting of the Society for Classical Studies, Chicago, IL, January 2024.

Pletcher, Charles, "Hippolytus Three Ways: The Limits of Sight and Sound in a Fatal Crash," Annual Meeting for Postgraduates in the Reception of the Ancient World, Online, November 2021.

Pletcher, Charles, "Writing a Digital Commentary on the New Alexandria Platform," Annual Meeting of the Society for Classical Studies, Online, January 2021.

Pletcher, Charles, "Angry Antigone: Anastrophē in Sophocles and Griselda Gambaro," Annual Meeting of the Society for Classical Studies, San Diego, CA, January 2019.

Pletcher, Charles, "Polyglot Micro-Services with a Dash of Wittgenstein," Polyglot Programming Conference, Poznań, Poland, July 2015.

Departmental Talks

Romanello, Matteo and **Charles Pletcher**, « Ajax Multi-Commentary : une plateforme numérique pour l'analyse des commentaires sur l'*Ajax* de Sophocle, » University of Lausanne, Institut d'Archéologie et des sciences de l'Antiquité, May 2024.

Levy, Izzy and **Charles Pletcher**, "Drama and Drag: Performing Aristophanes' *Thesmophoriazusae*," Female Agents: Gender, Drama, Reception, Performance: A Conference in Honor of Helene Foley, April 2023.

Pletcher, Charles, "The Power of the God: Owning the Bow in Sophocles' *Philoctetes*," Columbia University Classics Colloquium, February 2022.

DIGITAL/PUBLIC HUMANITIES PROJECTS

Perseus Project, Platform development, 2025–Present
Perseus Project, TEI/XML encoding for commentaries, 2023–2025
Ajax Multi-Commentary, Platform development, 2023–2024, https://multi.ajmc.ch
Inscriptions in Israel/Palestine, Search and maps development, 2023, https://search.inscriptionsisraelpalestine.org
Beyond Translation, IIIF manuscript viewer development, 2023, https://beyond-translation.perseus.org

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Tufts University, Department of Classical Studies

Advanced Greek: Homer (Fall 2025)
Introduction to Digital Humanities (Spring 2025, Fall 2025)
Quantitative Textual Analysis (Fall 2024, Fall 2025)

Columbia University, Core Curriculum

Literature Humanities (Fall 2021, Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Spring 2023)

Columbia University, Department of Classics

Intensive Elementary Greek (Summer 2022)
Elementary Greek (Fall 2019, Spring 2020; partially remote due to COVID-19 pandemic)
Intermediate Latin (Spring 2019)
Elementary Latin (Fall 2018)

HONORS AND AWARDS

Core Curriculum Preceptorship (competitive teaching fellowship), 2021–2023
Louis A. Parks Graduate Fellowship in Classics, Columbia University, 2021–2022
Lodge Fund Archaeology Grant to study modern receptions of Aeschylus in Siracusa, 2021
Lodge Fund Archaeology Grant to work towards reconstructing an ancient theater in Unity, 2020

Columbia University Conference Travel Grant, 2019
Lodge Fund Archaeology Grant for travel to the ancient theaters at Taormina and Tindari, 2019
Google Digital Humanities Grant, Classical Languages Toolkit, Summer 2017
Graduate Studies Fellowship, Dartmouth College, 2012–2013
Minnie Helen Hicks Prize, Brown University, 2012

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Universal Design for Learning Fellowship, Tufts University, Fall 2025–Spring 2026

SERVICE

Departmental

Mentor for post-baccalaureate students in Classics, 2021–2023
Representative, Arts and Sciences Graduate Council, 2018–2021
Rapporteur, University Seminar in Renaissance Studies, 2018–2019

LANGUAGES

Ancient

Greek
Latin
Aramaic (reading with dictionary)

Modern

English (native)
Spanish (advanced reading, speaking, and writing)
French (advanced reading, intermediate speaking and writing)
Italian (advanced reading, intermediate speaking and writing)
Catalan (reading)
German (reading)
Portuguese (reading)